

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the paralegal role supporting the Employment Litigation team at your emergency services client because the work sits directly within what I have been doing: managing case files, preparing bundles, conducting legal research and supporting proceedings through to hearing. My year at BCLP and my current role at Citizens Advice have given me practical experience of exactly that kind of work.

At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials, and tracked deadlines across several matters running concurrently. I also maintained case records on iManage and handled court filings. That experience of keeping litigation files organised and moving under pressure is directly relevant to the case management and bundle preparation this role requires. In the International Arbitration team I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline, coordinating outstanding documents and actions to ensure the memorial was filed on time. A partner and associate told me my performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor.

At Citizens Advice I interview clients across employment, housing, welfare and family matters, take detailed factual statements, establish chronologies and identify the key legal and evidential issues. I then manage those matters through to submission, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential records. Taking witness statements and translating complex procedural rules into clear guidance for clients in difficult situations is a core part of what I do every day. Given that the emergency services client operates in the public sector, I am also used to working with clients who may be under significant personal stress, and to maintaining accuracy and sensitivity in those circumstances.

The focus on Employment Tribunal work appeals to me because employment disputes often turn on procedural rigour and the quality of documentary preparation. The bundle and disclosure work I did in litigation at BCLP, combined with the factual investigation and client communication I do now at Citizens Advice, means I can contribute to this team from day one rather than learning the basics on the job.

I am available on short notice and am happy to discuss the role at a time that suits.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva